General Modeling Rules LeanIX

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Overview

The following modeling guidelines apply to all fact sheets that can be created by a user with the standard member role. These modelling guidelines must be observed and followed in any case. The implementation of the guidelines is tracked and tracked as part of the regular quality assurance measures.

If you have any questions about the guidelines described or if you need support, LeanIX support will be happy to help!

General Modeling Rules

📘 Subscriptions

In LeanIX, **subscriptions** are used to assign individuals and roles to a Fact Sheet. There are two main types of subscriptions:

- **Responsible**: Individuals accountable for the content and maintenance of the Fact Sheet.
- **Observer**: Individuals who are informed but not responsible for the content.

The specific roles that can be assigned to a Fact Sheet are defined in the modeling guidelines for each Fact Sheet type.

🔷 Responsibility Requirement

Each Fact Sheet must have **at least one person assigned as Responsible**. This person (or persons):

- Is accountable for the **accuracy, completeness, and currency** of the Fact Sheet.
- Receives **notifications** about changes to the Fact Sheet.
- Acts as the **primary contact** for questions, clarifications, or requirements related to the Fact Sheet.

🔷 Change of Responsibility

If a Responsible person:

- Changes roles,
- Leaves the company or department,
- Or is no longer involved with the Fact Sheet,

…it is their duty to ensure a **successor** is assigned to maintain the Fact Sheet.

🔷 Automated Quality Checks

LeanIX includes automated processes to ensure data quality. These processes include:

1. **Inactive Responsible Person**
   If a Responsible person is no longer active in the company or subsidiary (e.g., due to departure), the system checks for other Responsible persons:
   - If none exist, the **direct manager** of the former Responsible is identified and automatically assigned as the new Responsible.

    - The manager also receives a **To-Do** to assign a new, appropriate Responsible person.
    - This escalation continues up to the **department head level** if necessary.
2. **No Responsible Assigned**
   If no Responsible is assigned to a Fact Sheet:
    - The system uses the **"Responsible IT Department"** relation to identify the appropriate manager.
    - This manager is then assigned as the Responsible person and is expected to **nominate a qualified business owner**.

📘 Lifecycle Management in LeanIX Fact Sheets

Each **Fact Sheet type** in LeanIX can be assigned a **lifecycle**. Whether this assignment is **mandatory** depends on the specific Fact Sheet type and is indicated on its detail page.

🔷 Recommended Practice

Regardless of whether the lifecycle is mandatory, it is **strongly recommended** to provide the following information:

- **Start of productive use** (Go-Live date)
- **Decommissioning date** (if known)

Depending on the desired level of detail, additional lifecycle milestones can also be modeled (e.g., development start, pilot phase, sunset planning).

🔷 Benefits

Accurate lifecycle data supports:

- **Strategic planning** and **portfolio management**
- **Compliance** with regulatory and audit requirements
- **Impact analysis** for changes and decommissioning
- **Architecture governance** across all layers

📘 Organizational Responsibilities

Each Fact Sheet in LeanIX must include an assignment of **organizational responsibility**. This responsibility can be defined at two levels:

- **Organizational Structure Level** (e.g., departments, business units)
- **Process Organization Level** (e.g., Agile Release Trains, portfolios)

For certain Fact Sheet types, a distinction may also be made between **functional (business) responsibility** and **technical (IT) responsibility**.

> ✅ At least one form of responsibility must be specified—either at the organizational structure level or the process organization level.
> 🔄 Ideally, both levels should be documented to ensure full traceability and accountability.
>
> ⚠️ **If IT responsibility is defined as mandatory in the modeling guidelines for a specific Fact Sheet type, it must be provided without exception.**

Responsibility at the Organizational Structure Level

At Porsche, the **organizational structure** is defined by the official organizational chart, which organizes the company into hierarchical levels such as:

- Division
- Main Department
- Department
- Subdepartment (lowest level)

> In LeanIX modeling, unless explicitly stated otherwise, responsibility must always be assigned to the **lowest available level** of the organizational structure.

🔷 Example

If an IT Product is operationally managed by the **FDB1 department**, then the organizational Fact Sheet for **FDB1** must be assigned in LeanIX as the responsible unit.

> ❌ Assigning the higher-level unit **FDB** would be incorrect and violate modeling standards.

🔷 Key Principles

- Always reference the **most granular organizational unit** available.
- Ensure that the assigned unit reflects the **actual operational responsibility**.
- This ensures **clear accountability**, **accurate reporting**, and **effective governance**.

Responsibility at the Process Organization Level

Many IT products and applications at Porsche are developed and operated by **Agile Release Trains (ARTs)**. Others are managed within specific **portfolios**.

🔷 **Assignment Guidelines**

- If an **ART** is responsible for a product (or any other relevant Fact Sheet type), this responsibility must be **explicitly documented** in LeanIX by assigning the corresponding ART Fact Sheet.
- If the responsibility lies with a **single portfolio**—as is often the case with **P51 applications**—then assigning the portfolio is **sufficient**.

  ✅ Always ensure that the assigned ART or portfolio accurately reflects the **operational ownership** of the product.

🔷 **Key Principles**

- Use the **ART Fact Sheet** when agile teams are responsible for development and operations.
- Use the **Portfolio Fact Sheet** when responsibility is anchored in a business or IT portfolio.
- This ensures **clear accountability**, supports **agile governance**, and aligns with **LeanIX modeling standards**.

Please note

Only organizational fact sheets that are tagged with "**Synced**" or "**Manual**" may be used! The use of fact sheets with the tag "**Legacy**" is not allowed!

📘 Modeling Version History with Successor and Predecessor Relations

In LeanIX, the **Successor** and **Predecessor** relations are used to model the **version history** of Fact Sheets over time.

These relations should be applied whenever a **new version** of an existing Fact Sheet is created to **replace** an older version.

✅ Successor relations can also be used **while the previous version is still active** and in productive use.

Best Practice for Unused Relations

If no predecessor or successor exists for a given Fact Sheet, it is recommended to **explicitly set the relation field to**:

> **"Leave empty"**

This ensures clarity in the data model and avoids ambiguity in version tracking.

🔷 Key Principles

- Use **Successor/Predecessor** to document version transitions.
- Apply even if the older version is still operational.
- If not applicable, set the relation field to **"Leave empty"** instead of leaving it undefined.

📘 Modeling Hierarchies with Parent/Child Relations in LeanIX

In LeanIX, **Parent/Child relations** are used to model **hierarchical dependencies** between Fact Sheets. These relations help structure complex systems, portfolios, or organizational units by defining **logical containment** or **ownership hierarchies**.

🔷 Usage Guidelines

- A **Parent Fact Sheet** represents a higher-level entity that logically contains or governs one or more **Child Fact Sheets**.
- A **Child Fact Sheet** is a subordinate entity that inherits context or structure from its parent.

This relation is commonly used in the following scenarios:

Use Case	Parent Type	Child Type
Application Suite	Application	Application
Platform Composition	Platform	IT Component
Organizational Hierarchy	Organization Unit	Sub-Unit
Portfolio Structure	Portfolio	Product / Application

🔷 Special Rule for IT Products

> ⚠️ **For the Fact Sheet type "IT Product", the Parent/Child relation must only be used after prior consultation with the responsible Portfolio Architect and the LeanIX team.**
> This ensures that hierarchical modeling aligns with enterprise architecture principles and avoids misrepresentation of product structures.

🔷 Best Practices

- Use Parent/Child relations to **group related Fact Sheets** under a common context.
- Ensure that the hierarchy reflects **actual ownership or architectural structure**.
- Avoid circular or ambiguous relationships.
- Document the rationale for the hierarchy in the **description field** of the Fact Sheet if needed.
- ✅ **If the Parent/Child relation is not applicable**, explicitly set the field to **"Leave empty"** to ensure clarity and data quality.

🔷 Benefits

- Improves **navigability** and **traceability** in LeanIX.
- Supports **impact analysis** and **portfolio planning**.
- Enables **structured reporting** and **governance alignment**.

LLM-Ready Structure Summary

📊 LLM-Ready Structure Summary (LeanIX Modeling Guidelines)

Topic	Key Concepts	Rules / Requirements	Best Practices	Exceptions / Warnings	Benefits
Subscriptions	Responsible & Observer roles for Fact Sheets	- Each Fact Sheet must have at least one Responsible person - Responsible receives notifications and acts as contact	- Assign successors when roles change - Use automated checks to maintain data quality	- If no Responsible exists, system escalates to manager or department head	- Ensures accountability - Maintains data accuracy - Supports governance
Lifecycle Management	Lifecycle phases: Go-Live, Decommissioning, etc.	- Lifecycle assignment may be mandatory depending on Fact Sheet type	- Always provide Go-Live and Decommissioning dates - Include additional milestones if relevant	- None specified	- Supports strategic planning - Enables impact analysis - Ensures compliance
Organizational Responsibilities	Structure vs. Process-level responsibility	- At least one responsibility must be defined - IT responsibility mandatory if modeling guidelines require it	- Assign to lowest organizational level (e.g., Subdepartment) - Use ART or Portfolio Fact Sheets for process-level responsibility	- Do not assign higher-level units (e.g., FDB instead of FDB1) - Only use Fact Sheets tagged "Synced" or "Manual"	- Enables traceability - Aligns with governance - Improves reporting
Version History	Successor / Predecessor relations	- Use when creating new versions of Fact Sheets - Apply even if older version is still active	- If not applicable, explicitly set field to “Leave empty”	- Leaving field undefined causes ambiguity	- Clarifies version transitions - Improves data quality

Topic	Key Concepts	Rules / Requirements	Best Practices	Exceptions / Warnings	Benefits
Hierarchies	Parent / Child relations	- Parent = higher-level entity - Child = subordinate entity	- Use for grouping related Fact Sheets - Document rationale in description field - Explicitly set to “Leave empty” if not applicable	- For IT Products, use only after consulting Portfolio Architect and LeanIX team - Avoid circular or ambiguous relationships	- Improves navigability - Enables structured reporting - Supports impact analysis